

Conclusion

Overall Finding

Of the 1,470 employees analyzed, 237 left the organization — an overall attrition rate of **16.12%**, or roughly one in every six employees. On the surface this looks like a moderate, manageable figure. But breaking the number down by department, job role, income, overtime, tenure, age, and satisfaction shows that attrition is **not random** — it is heavily concentrated in a small number of predictable, overlapping employee segments. The organization does not have a broad-based retention problem; it has a specific one, and the data points clearly to where it lives.

The Core Pattern: Attrition Clusters Around a Few Repeating Conditions

Across every cut of the data, the same handful of conditions keep reappearing wherever attrition spikes:

Factor	Highest-risk segment	Attrition rate
Department	Sales	20.63%
Job role	Sales Representative	39.76%
Overtime	Employees working overtime	30.53% (vs. 10.44% without)
Income	Below ₹3,000/month	28.61%
Tenure	Under 2 years	34.88%
Age	Under 25	39.18%
Job satisfaction	Level 1 (lowest)	22.84%

No single factor tells the full story on its own — the R&D department, for example, has the lowest departmental attrition rate (13.84%) despite being the largest, and income differences between departments are too small to explain turnover by themselves. What matters is **how these factors compound**. The root-cause analysis makes this explicit: a young, overtime-working, low-income Sales Representative is not a moderate-risk employee — they are an extreme-risk one, with attrition rates as high as 56–67% when these conditions stack together.

Why This Matters: Attrition Is a Compounding Risk, Not an Isolated One

Three findings, taken together, explain most of the attrition in this dataset:

1. **Overtime is the strongest single lever.** Employees working overtime leave at nearly 3x the rate of those who don't (30.53% vs. 10.44%), and this holds true in every department. Overtime also amplifies every other risk factor — it turns a 28.47% attrition rate for frequent travelers into 41.86%, and turns low-income attrition from a serious problem into a 56.14% crisis.
2. **Attrition is front-loaded in the employee lifecycle.** Employees under 2 years of tenure (34.88%) and under 25 years of age (39.18%) leave at more than double the organizational average. These two groups also earn the least. Early tenure isn't just correlated with leaving — it's the single strongest predictor in the dataset outside of overtime.
3. **Compensation matters most at the bottom, not on average.** Department-level income differences are small and don't explain attrition (Sales pays the most and still has the highest attrition). But the income-tier analysis tells a different story: employees earning under ₹3,000/month attrite at 28.61%, nearly double the organizational rate, and this effect nearly doubles again when combined with overtime.

What This Means for the Business

Because R&D holds 65% of the workforce, its attrition — while proportionally the lowest — still accounts for the largest absolute number of departures (133 employees) and deserves monitoring. But **proportional risk, not headcount, is where intervention will have the highest return.** Sales Representatives, Laboratory Technicians, and early-tenure/early-career employees represent a small share of total headcount but a disproportionate share of turnover, replacement cost, and lost institutional knowledge.

Final Conclusion

Employee attrition in this dataset is best understood not as a single 16% problem, but as a **small set of severe, overlapping problems hiding inside a moderate average.** The strongest, most consistent driver is overtime, which by itself nearly triples attrition risk and compounds every other factor it touches — age, income, job role, travel, and tenure. The organization's highest-leverage opportunity is therefore not a company-wide retention program, but a **targeted intervention** aimed at:

- Reducing or better compensating overtime, especially in Sales and R&D operational roles
- Strengthening onboarding, mentoring, and early-career support in the first two years of employment
- Reviewing base pay for the lowest income tier, where retention risk is highest regardless of role
- Prioritizing support for high-risk roles specifically — Sales Representatives (39.76%) and Laboratory Technicians (23.94%) — rather than applying uniform policy across all job

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Addressing these four levers would directly target the employee segments responsible for the majority of attrition in this dataset, rather than spreading retention resources thinly across a workforce where most employees are, in fact, already staying.